WEEK 7 · LECTURE L1 · UNIT III

From Engagement Data to Strategy

Saks's antecedents and consequences, social exchange and perceived support, engagement and performance, and the engagement value chain.

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AFTER THIS LECTURE YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO

What this lecture prepares you for

- Explain Saks's model of job and organization engagement.
- Explain social exchange theory and perceived organizational support.
- Evaluate the evidence that engagement predicts performance.
- Prioritize engagement drivers by impact and feasibility.

COURSE OUTCOMES

CLO 2 (apply engagement strategies) and CLO 4 (analyze data and design evidence based interventions).

COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

People engage because they are paid to.

Agree or disagree. What do employees give back when the organization gives more than pay?

SAKS (2006)

Antecedents and consequences of engagement

Antecedents	Engagement	Consequences
Job characteristics	Job engagement	Job satisfaction
Perceived organizational and supervisor support	Organization engagement	Organizational commitment
Rewards and recognition		Lower intention to quit
Procedural and distributive justice		Citizenship behavior

EXAM LENS

Saks separated engagement with the job from engagement with the organization; they had different antecedents.

THEORY IN DEPTH · SAKS (2006)

Job and organization engagement are different

THE CORE IDEA

Engagement has two targets, the job and the organization, explained by social exchange.

HOW IT WORKS

Perceived support predicted both; job characteristics predicted job engagement; procedural justice predicted organization engagement.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

One survey of 102 employees: small, cross sectional and self reported.

IN PRACTICE

A firm with fair promotion processes but dull jobs may see loyalty to the firm without energy in the work.

EXAM LENS

Use it to argue that one engagement score hides two different problems with different remedies.

THEORY IN DEPTH · CROPANZANO AND MITCHELL (2005); EISENBERGER ET AL. (1986)

Social exchange and perceived support

THE CORE IDEA

When the organization provides resources and care, employees repay with effort, commitment and engagement.

HOW IT WORKS

Employees form a belief about how much the firm values them; this links to commitment and performance (Rhoades and Eisenberger, 2002).

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Exchange norms vary across cultures and relationships; reciprocity is not automatic.

IN PRACTICE

A manufacturer that supports employees through a family medical emergency sees loyalty that pay alone did not buy.

EXAM LENS

The theory beneath Saks. Use it to explain why engagement responds to support, not only to pay.

THEORY IN DEPTH · CHRISTIAN, GARZA AND SLAUGHTER (2011)

Does engagement predict performance?

THE CORE IDEA

Work engagement related to both task performance and contextual performance.

HOW IT WORKS

It did so beyond job attitudes; job characteristics, leadership and dispositions predicted engagement.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Meta analytic correlations; many studies used single sources.

IN PRACTICE

An engagement program justified only by satisfaction scores misses its stronger link to performance.

EXAM LENS

Cite it for the business case for engagement, alongside Rich et al. (2010) from Week 2.

THE ENGAGEMENT VALUE CHAIN · MACEY ET AL. (2009)

From conditions to outcomes

CONDITIONS

Work and leadership that make engagement possible

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FEELINGS

Energy, absorption, enthusiasm

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BEHAVIORS

Persistence, initiative, role expansion

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OUTCOMES

Performance, retention, customer results

Impact against feasibility

	Low feasibility	High feasibility
High impact	Plan carefully; stage it	Act now
Low impact	Drop	Quick wins, if cheap

EXAM LENS

Feasibility includes manager capacity and willingness, not only budget. This matrix is a course framework, not a published model.

PRACTICE FOR THE END TERM EXAMINATION

Questions to rehearse

Explain Saks's model of employee engagement and evaluate its contribution. **20 marks**

A strong answer: explains antecedents, the two targets and consequences; links to social exchange; notes sample limits; applies to a firm.

"Engagement is a business outcome, not a feel good measure." Discuss with evidence. **20 marks**

A strong answer: uses Christian et al. and the value chain; separates conditions, state and behavior; notes correlational limits.

What is perceived organizational support? **10 marks**

A strong answer: defines it; cites Eisenberger et al.; one outcome it predicts.

CARRY THESE INTO THE EXAMINATION

Three things to remember

1. Engagement with the job and with the organization have different causes
2. Employees repay support with engagement: social exchange
3. Engagement predicts task and contextual performance

SET READINGS · FROM THE LESSON PLAN

Read for this lecture

Saks, A. M. (2006). Antecedents and consequences of employee engagement. *Journal of Managerial Psychology, 21*(7), 600–619.

Macey, W. H., Schneider, B., Barbera, K. M., & Young, S. A. (2009). *Employee engagement: Tools for analysis, practice, and competitive advantage*. Wiley Blackwell. Chapters 1 to 2.

People Matters and SHRM India: a selected case on an Indian engagement transformation (Wipro, Infosys or HCLTech), as listed in the Lesson Plan.

HOW TO USE THESE

These are the Week 7 set readings. Saks (2006) is the core reading for this lecture.

Sources for this lecture (1 of 2)

Works named on the slides of this lecture. They are background sources, not set readings.

Christian, M. S., Garza, A. S., & Slaughter, J. E. (2011). Work engagement: A quantitative review and test of its relations with task and contextual performance. *Personnel Psychology, 64*(1), 89–136. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1744-6570.2010.01203.x

Cropanzano, R., & Mitchell, M. S. (2005). Social exchange theory: An interdisciplinary review. *Journal of Management, 31*(6), 874–900. https://doi.org/10.1177/0149206305279602

Eisenberger, R., Huntington, R., Hutchison, S., & Sowa, D. (1986). Perceived organizational support. *Journal of Applied Psychology, 71*(3), 500–507. https://doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.71.3.500

Sources for this lecture (2 of 2)

Macey, W. H., Schneider, B., Barbera, K. M., & Young, S. A. (2009). *Employee engagement: Tools for analysis, practice, and competitive advantage*. Wiley Blackwell.

Rhoades, L., & Eisenberger, R. (2002). Perceived organizational support: A review of the literature. *Journal of Applied Psychology, 87*(4), 698–714. https://doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.87.4.698

Rich, B. L., LePine, J. A., & Crawford, E. R. (2010). Job engagement: Antecedents and effects on job performance. *Academy of Management Journal, 53*(3), 617–635. https://doi.org/10.5465/amj.2010.51468988

Saks, A. M. (2006). Antecedents and consequences of employee engagement. *Journal of Managerial Psychology, 21*(7), 600–619. https://doi.org/10.1108/02683940610690169